

Date: 2/4/2026

Start Time: 9:30 pm

End Time: 12:30 am

Challenges / Roadblocks: What I found to be the most difficult was the last flag to not get denied from the IDS which took some research into how to work around IDS/IPS rules.

Total number of flags: 9/9

Flag 1: Windows, based on the TTL 128 provided which indicates a windows machine.

Flag 2: 7, used a general nmap scan command to find the open tcp ports that were listed.

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-iusk12ccc5]-[~]  
[★]$ sudo nmap 10.129.29.136
```

Flag 3: NIX-NMAP-DEFAULT, took a more aggressive approach that took longer than expected to scan everything in a more less stealthy way, which if you tried to do something undetected would not be the best command but is more accurate to obtain information on a host such as the OS and hostname.

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-iusk12ccc5]-[~]  
[★]$ sudo nmap 10.129.29.136 -A
```

Flag 4: 31337, having the scan download an .xml file with -oX, and then converted the .xml file to an html file to be readable most beneficial for documentation when giving a pen test report.

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-iusk12ccc5]-[~]  
[★]$ sudo nmap 10.129.29.136 -oX fullscan.xml
```

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-iusk12ccc5]-[~]  
[★]$ xsltproc fullscan.xml -o fullscan.html
```

Flag 5: HTB{pr0F7pDv3r510nb4nn3r}, used port 31337 which was open and netcat to extract the header to get the flag.

```
Parrot Terminal
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
[*]$ sudo nmap 10.129.2.49 -p- -sV
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-02-04 22:21 CST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.2.49
Host is up (0.0099s latency).
Not shown: 65528 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE      VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh          OpenSSH 7.6p1 Ubuntu 4ubuntu0.7 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
80/tcp    open  http         Apache httpd 2.4.29 ((Ubuntu))
110/tcp   open  pop3         Dovecot pop3d
139/tcp   open  netbios-ssn Samba smbd 3.X - 4.X (workgroup: WORKGROUP)
143/tcp   open  imap         Dovecot imapd (Ubuntu)
445/tcp   open  netbios-ssn Samba smbd 3.X - 4.X (workgroup: WORKGROUP)
31337/tcp open  ftp          ProFTPD
Service Info: Host: NIX-NMAP-DEFAULT; OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 62.60 seconds
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mvnbdrrz3kj]-[~]
[*]$ nc 10.129.2.49 31337
220 HTB{pr0F7pDv3r510nb4nn3r}
^C
```

Flag 6: HTB{873nniuc71bu6usbs1i96as6dsv26}, port 80 was open and was able to obtain a file in the sever using wget to download the file to the instance and cat command to open it and get the flag.

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mvnbdrrz3kj]-[~]
[*]$ wget http://10.129.2.49/robots.txt
--2026-02-04 23:25:45-- http://10.129.2.49/robots.txt
Connecting to 10.129.2.49:80... connected.
HTTP request sent, awaiting response... 200 OK
length: 60 [text/plain]
saving to: 'robots.txt'

robots.txt          100%[=====]          60 --.-KB/s    in 0s

2026-02-04 23:25:45 (7.71 MB/s) - 'robots.txt' saved [60/60]

[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mvnbdrrz3kj]-[~]
[*]$ ls
acert.der Desktop Documents Downloads Music Pictures Public robots.txt Templates Videos
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mvnbdrrz3kj]-[~]
[*]$ cat robots.txt
User-agent: *

Allow: /

HTB{873nniuc71bu6usbs1i96as6dsv26}
```

Flag 7: Ubuntu, from using the obtain OS command with a stealthier -T 3 approach to not set off the IDS/IPS. Which takes longer but will look like normal flow of traffic instead of scanning the network or port.

```

[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mnohmjh8km]-[~]
[★]$ sudo nmap -sV 10.129.29.193 -O -T 3
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-02-05 00:40 CST
Stats: 0:00:51 elapsed; 0 hosts completed (1 up), 1 undergoing Service Scan
Service scan Timing: About 66.67% done; ETC: 00:41 (0:00:25 remaining)
Stats: 0:01:35 elapsed; 0 hosts completed (1 up), 1 undergoing Service Scan
Service scan Timing: About 66.67% done; ETC: 00:42 (0:00:47 remaining)
Stats: 0:02:58 elapsed; 0 hosts completed (1 up), 1 undergoing Script Scan
NSE Timing: About 0.00% done
Nmap scan report for 10.129.29.193
Host is up (0.0089s latency).
Not shown: 869 closed tcp ports (reset), 128 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE      VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh          OpenSSH 7.6p1 Ubuntu 4ubuntu0.7 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)

```

Flag 8: HTB{GoTtgUnyze9Psw4vGjcuMpHRp}, did a regular nmap scan with the IP provided, with sending UDP packets, spoofing the port that it was coming from, and using Pn to force nmap to scan the IP.

```

[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-mnohmjh8km]-[~]
[★]$ sudo nmap 10.129.29.219 -sV -p 53 --source-port 53 -Pn -sU
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-02-05 01:03 CST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.29.219
Host is up (0.010s latency).

PORT      STATE SERVICE      VERSION
53/udp    open  domain      (unknown banner: HTB{GoTtgUnyze9Psw4vGjcuMpHRp})
1 service unrecognized despite returning data. If you know the service/version,
please submit the following fingerprint at https://nmap.org/cgi-bin/submit.cgi?new-service :

```

Flag 9: HTB{kjnsdf2n982n1827eh76238s98di1w6}, used an nmap scan using -sS so it does not make a full connection, -Pn to skip host discovery, and making the source port come from 53 because it can pass IDS/IPS detection looking like essential traffic. Performed a -sV scan on port 50000. Then used ncat to get the banner to get the flag.

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-yop1zoh64h]-[~]
[★]$ sudo nmap -sS -Pn -n --source-port 53 10.129.31.246
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-02-05 21:36 CST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.31.246
Host is up (0.0094s latency).
Not shown: 869 closed tcp ports (reset), 128 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
22/tcp    open  ssh
80/tcp    open  http
50000/tcp open  ibm-db2
```

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 2.67 seconds

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-yop1zoh64h]-[~]
[★]$ sudo nmap -sV -p 50000 -Pn -n --source-port 53 10.129.31.246
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-02-05 21:36 CST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.31.246
Host is up (0.0092s latency).

PORT      STATE SERVICE  VERSION
50000/tcp open  tcpwrapped
```

```
[us-academy-2]-[10.10.15.217]-[htb-ac-2296985@htb-yop1zoh64h]-[~]
[★]$ sudo ncat -nv --source-port 53 10.129.31.246 50000
Ncat: Version 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org/ncat )
Ncat: Connected to 10.129.31.246:50000.
220 HTB{kjnsdf2n982n1827eh76238s98di1w6}
```